IT CONSULTANT CHALLENGE 2026 · ROUND 1

Keeping the delivery promise across three markets

A fulfilment control layer on top of Company A’s existing systems in Denmark, Norway and Sweden

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October 2026

WHICH PROBLEM WE PRIORITISE

Fulfilment is where one solution shows value fastest

Later

Fragmented systems

Replacing systems in three countries takes years and conflicts with “time to market is critical”.

Later

Manual processes

High impact, but the brief does not say which processes are manual, so an MVP would rest on a guess.

Later

Inconsistent operations

A symptom of different ways of working. Hard to show measurable impact quickly.

Prioritised

Delivery and fulfilment

Concrete, customer-facing and measurable. Works on top of existing systems, so it also starts to reduce fragmentation.

WHO EXPERIENCES IT AND WHY IT MATTERS

A broken delivery promise hurts three groups at once

Customers

Construction businesses lose a working day when materials arrive late or incomplete. Consumers wait without knowing why.

Store and distribution staff

Answering “where is my order?” means checking several systems and calling colleagues and carriers.

Management

No shared view of delivery performance, so improvements in one country cannot be scaled to the others.

Reliability is what lets Company A compete and serve its customers effectively in a highly competitive market.

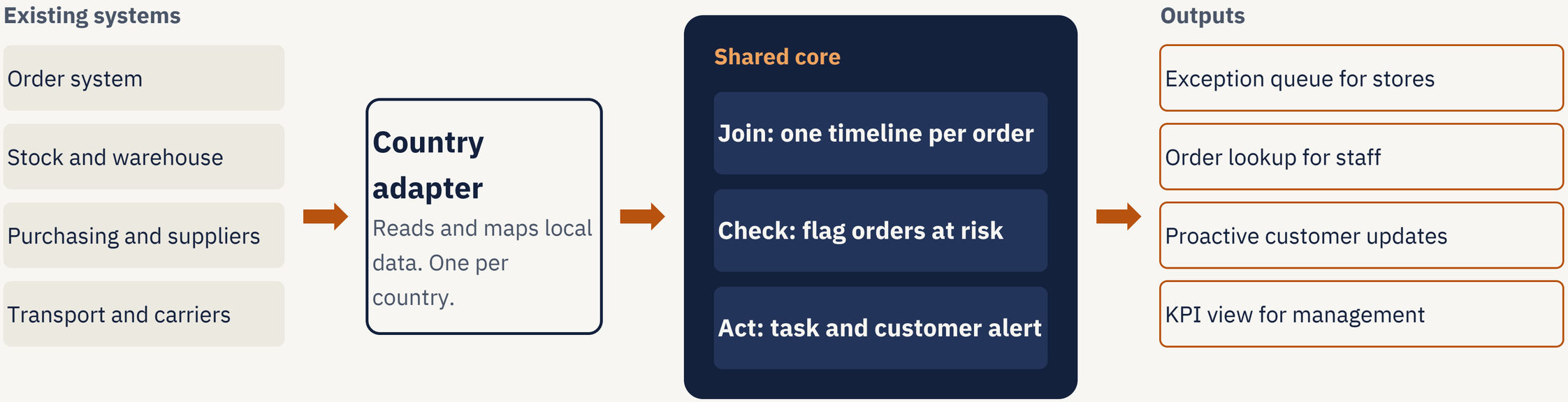
KEY ASSUMPTIONS

Where the brief is silent, we assume and justify

Assumption	Why it is reasonable
One order is often fulfilled from several sources: store, warehouse, supplier	The brief separates store and distribution operations
Order, stock, purchasing and transport data sit in systems that do not share data	Follows from each country building its own systems
Most delays start before the truck leaves	An order can only leave on time if every part is ready
Every system can at least export order and delivery data	Standard for retail order and finance systems
Sweden feels fulfilment pain the most	Matches the brief’s own example for Sweden

PROPOSED SOLUTION

A control layer that joins, checks and acts



One strategic solution: the same model, risk check and user features in every market.

Not one identical implementation: local adapters, cut-off times, language and channels.

HOW IT WORKS: ONE ORDER

Order 1001 is caught two days before it fails

Promised to a construction customer for Wednesday

Line	Source	Status	Check
A	Store stock	Picked	On track
B	Central warehouse	Not yet picked	Watch
C	Supplier	Confirmed for Thursday	**At risk**

Each line comes from a different system. Only the joined timeline shows the conflict.

What the layer does

1. Opens an exception for the store: “Line C late by one day”.
2. Suggests a fix: deliver A and B on Wednesday, C on Thursday.
3. Informs the customer early, in their own language.

OPTIONS WE CONSIDERED

Why a control layer, not a bigger change first

Option	Why it is weaker as a first step
Replace all systems with one platform	Takes years and carries high risk; conflicts with “time to market is critical”
Direct integrations between systems	Integrations multiply with every system and country; still no single view of an order
Data warehouse with daily reports	Shows problems after they happen; no task for staff and no update for the customer
Full order management system	Must write into every country’s systems and change processes all at once
Read-only control layer (our choice)	**Fast, low risk, actionable, reusable through adapters, and can grow into an OMS later**

WHERE AI CREATES VALUE

AI only where simple rules fall short

AI use	Why rules alone are not enough	Phase
Adapter mapping assistant	Mapping each country’s data is the slowest part of every rollout	MVP
Multilingual customer messages	Every delay mixes different reasons and parts; templates cannot cover them all	MVP
Delay-risk prediction	Finds suppliers or stores that are often late even when status looks fine	After pilot
Suggested fix	Weighs stock, distance and customer priority across many options	Later

The MVP works without AI. AI shortens time to market and improves the result, but the core value never depends on it.

MVP SCOPE

One market, read-only, about 12 weeks

In scope

- Sweden, a limited set of pilot stores
- One adapter: order, stock, purchasing, transport
- Common order model and rule-based risk check
- Exception queue and order lookup for staff
- Delay notifications on one customer channel
- AI: mapping assistant and message texts

Out of scope

- Writing back into existing systems
- Replacing any existing system
- All three markets at once
- Live driver tracking and route optimisation
- AI delay-risk prediction

12-week plan (assumed)

Weeks 1–3
Map Swedish data, measure the baseline

Weeks 4–7
Adapter, order model and risk rules

Weeks 8–10
Staff screens and alerts, test in 2 stores

Weeks 11–12
Go live in pilot stores, compare with baseline

ROLLOUT ACROSS MARKETS

One core, adapted to each country

Phase 1 · Pilot

Sweden

Prove impact where fulfilment matters most. Staff co-design the pilot.

Phase 2 · Expand

Denmark and Norway

New adapters and local rules. Denmark: less manual chasing. Norway: one way to handle exceptions.

Phase 3 · Extend

All markets

AI risk prediction, suggested fixes and write-back into existing systems.

Key risks and how we handle them

Poor or inconsistent data

Data checks in each adapter; the pilot validates the order model before rollout

Old systems without APIs

Scheduled file exports instead; data becomes hourly, still far better than today

Staff do not adopt it

No extra data entry, staff co-design the pilot, rollout goes store by store

MEASURABLE BUSINESS IMPACT

What the Sweden pilot could deliver in one year

1,200

fewer problem deliveries, about EUR 120,000 saved (30% of 4,000)

400 h

employee time freed by halving “where is my order?” contacts

KPI	Baseline	Pilot target
On-time and complete delivery rate	90% (assumed)	93%
Delays flagged at least one day ahead	Measured in weeks 1–3	60% or more
“Where is my order?” contacts	10,000 a year (assumed)	–50%

Assumed: 20 pilot stores, 40,000 deliveries a year, 10% problem rate, EUR 100 per problem delivery